

DAILY MARKET OVERVIEW

Institutional-Grade Intelligence for Active Traders

Thursday, March 26, 2026 | Pre-Market Edition

MARKET SNAPSHOT — MARCH 25 CLOSE

Index	Last	Change	% Chg	Signal
S&P 500	6,591.90	+35.35	+0.54%	BULLISH
Dow Jones	46,429	+305	+0.66%	BULLISH
Nasdaq	21,929	+167	+0.77%	BULLISH
Brent Crude	\$96.80	-3.20	-3.20%	WATCH
WTI Crude	\$90.10	-2.40	-2.60%	WATCH
Fed Funds Rate	3.50-3.75%	Unchanged	—	HOLD

MACRO OVERVIEW

Dominant Theme: US-Iran Diplomatic Breakthrough Hopes

Markets staged a broad-based rally on Wednesday as reports emerged that the Trump administration sent a formal 15-point peace proposal to Tehran via Pakistan, signaling a potential off-ramp to a conflict that has rattled global markets since early March. Oil pulled back sharply — Brent fell below \$97 and WTI dipped toward \$90 — relieving inflationary pressure that had threatened to delay Federal Reserve rate cuts.

Federal Reserve Stance

At its March 18 meeting, the Fed held the benchmark rate at **3.50%–3.75%** and signaled **one 25 bps cut** before year-end. The latest SEP raised the PCE inflation forecast to **2.7%** but projects a return toward the 2% target as war-related energy and supply-chain pressures fade. The Fed is firmly in wait-and-see mode — any ceasefire confirmation could accelerate the rate-cut timeline.

Key Risks to Monitor

- Iran negotiations could collapse — talks remain preliminary and unverified
- Strait of Hormuz still effectively closed; insurance withdrawal limits tanker traffic
- Sticky inflation: PCE at 2.7% constrains Fed flexibility
- Geopolitical escalation risk: any military incident could spike oil back to \$115–\$120
- Indian markets closed today (Ram Navami); may lag tomorrow on catch-up moves

TOP MOVERS — WEDNESDAY SESSION

Ticker	Name	Move	Catalyst
INTC	Intel	+7.1%	CPU price hike announcement (Nikkei Asia)
AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	+7.0%	Joined Intel in CPU pricing hike, AI demand

NVDA	Nvidia	+2.0%	Continued AI buildout momentum
GE	GE Aerospace	+2.1%	Softer inflation outlook, industrial demand
JPM	JPMorgan Chase	+1.1%	Financial sector rally on easing oil fears
XOM	ExxonMobil	-1.3%	Lower oil prices on ceasefire hopes
CVX	Chevron	-1.1%	Oil pullback weighs on energy sector

SECTOR SCORECARD

Sector	Performance	Outlook
Technology / Semiconductors	Strong Outperformer	Bullish — CPU pricing power + AI buildout
Financials	Moderate Outperformer	Bullish — easing inflation, rate-cut hopes
Industrials / Aerospace	Moderate Outperformer	Neutral-to-Bullish — defense demand vs. peace
Consumer Cyclical	In Line	Neutral — wage growth supportive
Energy	Underperformer	Bearish Short-term — oil pullback on peace talks
Healthcare / Medtech	In Line	Bullish Long-term — defensive with growth
Cybersecurity	In Line	Bullish — geopolitical threat environment elevated

SHORT-TERM TRADING STRATEGY (1–5 DAYS)

The primary driver is geopolitical optionality around the Iran peace talks. The high-probability short-term playbook is to position for continued risk-on if ceasefire progress is confirmed, while hedging against a swift reversal if talks fail.

Trade	Direction	Horizon	Thesis	Risk
INTC	LONG	1–3 Days	CPU price hikes restore pricing power narrative; momentum above \$45 key	HIGH
AMD	LONG	1–3 Days	Beneficiary of CPU pricing cycle + AI inference demand; follow-through expected	HIGH
NVDA	LONG	2–5 Days	AI infrastructure spending continues; pullbacks to 10-day MA are buy opportunities	MED
PANW	LONG	2–5 Days	Elevated cyber threat environment; IV 37.3% — consider call spreads	MED
USO/XLE	SHORT	1–3 Days	Oil pulling back on ceasefire news; energy sector underperforms risk-on regime	HIGH
RTX	OPTIONS	2–5 Days	IV 31.6% — straddle ahead of any ceasefire/escalation announcements	MED

Day-Trade Focus: Watch pre-market futures for any Iran headline. A confirmed ceasefire or breakdown in talks will be the single most impactful catalyst of the session. Semiconductor stocks (INTC, AMD, NVDA) are the cleanest momentum vehicles in the current environment. Fade energy on any oil bounce above \$100.

MEDIUM & LONG-TERM STRATEGY (2 WEEKS – 6 MONTHS)

The structural landscape favors technology and select defensives. Even if the Iran conflict persists near-term, the AI-driven semiconductor super-cycle and a Fed on the verge of cutting create a powerful tailwind for growth assets on a 3–6 month horizon.

Trade	Direction	Horizon	Thesis	Risk
TSMC	LONG	3–6 Mo	Record margins, 58% revenue from AI/HPC, \$122B FY25 revenue. Core AI infrastructure play	LOW-MED
NVDA	LONG	3–6 Mo	Hyperscaler capex cycle intact; every ceasefire brings risk appetite back to growth	MED
PANW	LONG	1–3 Mo	Nation-state cyber threats elevate enterprise security budgets regardless of peace talks	MED
MDT	LONG	3–6 Mo	Medtronic: Dividend Aristocrat, largest pure-play medtech. Defensive + growth combo	LOW
BROS	LONG	3–6 Mo	Dutch Bros: expanding SSS + white-space store growth; consumer resiliency play	MED
XOM/CVX	AVOID	1–3 Mo	Energy sector faces headwinds if ceasefire materializes; re-enter on confirmed escalation	—

Portfolio Construction Note: Maintain 60–70% allocation to technology and AI infrastructure. Keep 10–15% in defensive healthcare (MDT) and consumer growth (BROS). Hold 10% cash/T-Bills as a hedge against geopolitical shock. Avoid commodities-heavy positions until oil finds a new equilibrium post-ceasefire.

KEY EVENTS CALENDAR — NEXT 5 SESSIONS

Date	Event	Expected Impact
Mar 26 (Today)	Iran Peace Talks — Ongoing / Headline Risk	CRITICAL — Oil & Risk Assets
Mar 27	India NSE/BSE Markets Reopen (post-holiday)	MODERATE — EM sentiment
Mar 27	Weekly Jobless Claims (US)	MODERATE — Fed rate-cut timeline
Mar 28	PCE Price Index (Feb) — Inflation Read	HIGH — Fed policy expectations
Mar 31	Q1 2026 End — Portfolio Rebalancing Flows	MODERATE — Sector rotation potential

TRADER WATCHLIST

MOMENTUM: INTC, AMD, NVDA, AVGO, MU — Semiconductor complex leading the tape. Any pullback to intraday VWAP is a potential entry.

GEOPOLITICAL HEDGE: RTX, NOC, LMT — Defense names sell off if ceasefire confirmed; spike if talks collapse. Options premium elevated — consider iron condors.

OIL RANGE TRADE: WTI \$85–\$100 appears to be the near-term range. Sell USO above \$100; buy XLE selectively near \$85 WTI if peace talks fail.

RATE-SENSITIVE: TLT, IEF — Bond prices rally if PCE Friday comes in soft. Position ahead of Mar 28 PCE print.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Wednesday's session delivered a clear message: markets want to price in peace. The broad rally — led by technology and industrials while energy faded — is a classic risk-on rotation consistent with declining oil prices and easing geopolitical tension. The Fed remains a net tailwind with rates near their cycle peak and a cut still expected before year-end. Semiconductors are the cleanest trade in the current environment, driven by both near-term pricing power catalysts (CPU hikes) and the long-term AI infrastructure spending cycle. The single largest risk is Iran talk failure — monitor news flow vigilantly. Keep position sizes disciplined; this is a headline-driven market.

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